

Vellumton, ruled jointly by Baron Arawn and Baroness Ellonwy, both of House Fiona. Including the University of Georgia and the nearby towns of Athens, Jackson, and Watkinsville, Wisteria draws artists, musicians, and many medieval recreationists. The changelings of Wisteria Hall oppose King Meilge but cannot yet act directly against him.

The Duchy of Palmetto (South Carolina)

The fae of South Carolina's Duchy of Palmetto follow, to varying degrees, the rule of Duke Antioan of House Liam, who resides at Palmetto Court, in Charleston. Born into a Vietnamese refugee family, the Seelie duke has raised many eyebrows at faerie courts throughout the Kingdom of Willows due to his unusual parentage, and has tested the innate assumptions of many of the sidhe. Taking on the title of acting Duke when Duchess Mischala of House Fiona started to slip into Bedlam, he demonstrated such a talent for rulership that when the duchess returned, she insisted he retain the title. Not yet confirmed by King Meilge, however, Duke Antioan's rule still rests on eggshells.

The Home Place, located in Beaufort, near the Sea Islands, serves as a gathering place for the fae born into the Gullah people who live on the islands. Cientilla, a tiny eshu grump, has ruled for decades as the "Mistress of the Gullah Free Lands." While acknowledging the Kingdom of Concordia, the Gullah fae hold themselves separate and independent from Concordia's Kithain politics. The preservation of the Gullah heritage remains her main concern, and she willingly shares her lore and knowledge with those who show an interest.

The Duchy of the Triangle (Central and Eastern North Carolina)

The state of North Carolina contains two duchies due to the vast differences between the fae of the western mountains and those of the rest of the state. The Duchy of the Triangle, the larger of the two, centers on the three cities of Raleigh-Durham-and-Chapel Hill. From his freehold, Trinity Manor, near Chapel Hill, Duke Murdoch of House Dougal ("The Professor") enjoys the support of his people and the friendship of King Meilge. Relocated to the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill from his native Glasgow, Murdoch displays a distinctly unsidhelike interest in mechanical engineering and theoretical sciences. His best friend and assistant, the nocker Richard "Rooster" Langolier, works with him on their common love: antique and race cars. Both gain Glamour from attendance at NASCAR and other racing events.

The Duchy of Appalachia (Western North Carolina, eastern Tennessee, and southeastern Kentucky)

The Duchy of Appalachia consists of parts of three states and contains their common focus — the Blue Ridge, Cumberland, and Great Smoky Mountains of the Appalachian Mountain chain. Many commoners and only a few sidhe live in this magi-

cal region. Whether commoner or noble, the Appalachian fae feel closer to one another than to those of their Kith or house in other parts of Concordia.

Orchard Castle, near Jonesborough, Tennessee, forms the seat of the duchy. Ruled by Duchess Dianan of House Fiona, this small palace, with a mortal seeming of a run-down shack, sits within an idyllic glade. The duchess, along with her troll guardian, Count Bjorno, hold court events outside among the lush mountain greenery. The duchess makes money in the mortal world by writing romance novels.

The Court of Balsam, also called the House of the Black Dome, occupies a campsite near the top of Mt. Mitchell, the highest peak in the eastern US. The Countess Toireasa holds court here in a charming wooden hunting lodge filled with her own paintings of mountain scenes. She has made a point of allying with the native Nunnehi in the area, which guarantees her a great degree of safety and security.

Near Oak Ridge, Tennessee, Lord Gadiel of House Balor has claimed a ruined mansion near a gnarled and twisted oak tree as his freehold of Twisted Oak. Very few fae visit this eerie place; the ones who do come there do so by night. Rumors of twisted goings-on within the confines of the freehold have never been investigated.

The twin peaks of Chimney Top, in the Great Smoky Mountains, still serve as a dancing ground for the local Nunnehi. Due to its popularity as a hiking destination, the Nunnehi have learned to hold their meetings when no hikers are nearby.

The Duchy of Blue Grasses (Most of Kentucky)

The Rose Garland Stables, near Lexington, Kentucky, produces fine thoroughbred racing horses. It also houses a freehold, accessed through a nearby rock grotto, ruled by the Kinain Duke Araby of House Gwydion. The child of a sidhe mother and her mortal husband, Araby's mortal guise and fae mien differ only in the lush decadence of his fae side. In the Near Dreaming, Araby raises faerie steeds, popular among some sidhe who enjoy racing them. Araby receives handsome payments of dross for his steeds, though he keeps the best for himself. His own steed, the black stallion Glamour's Beauty, stays hidden from most of the fae, because this horse is the mount for none other than "Lord Justice," a fae vigilante who visits retribution upon the corrupt fae, whether Seelie or Unseelie, for deeds that might otherwise go unpunished. Some of the duke's subjects feel that Lord Justice would make a better ruler than the effete, horse-crazy duke.

The Freehold of the Mammoth exists amid the complex system of underground caverns and tunnels that make up Kentucky's Mammoth Caves. A motley of sluagh, led by the matriarch Jiruna, discovered stores of Glamour deep within the caves and portioned out a section of caverns not visited by tourists as their freehold. Lit by a Balefire stolen from the Duchy of Blue Grasses, the freehold provides an ideal refuge for the dark-loving kith, its vast rooms carrying the soft whispers of the sluagh without harming their sensitive ears. Here, the sluagh